TEXAS STAAR

GRADE 8

Reading Language Arts & Mathematics

All-in-One Study & Practice Guide

8 Full-Length Practice Tests · Complete Skill Review · Deep Answer Explanations

Short & Extended Constructed Response Mastery · Score Diagnostics

100% aligned to the Texas Essential Knowledge and Skills (TEKS)

2027 EDITION

Adrian Ross

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This book is an **independent study guide**. It is **not affiliated with, authorized by, sponsored by, or endorsed by the Texas Education Agency** or any other Texas state agency. All references to STAAR and the TEKS are made solely for identification and educational alignment purposes.

All passages, questions, graphics, and practice materials in this book are **original works** created for instructional practice. They are designed to reflect the style, format, difficulty, and standards coverage of the STAAR Grade 8 assessment; they are **not** actual test questions and are **not** reproduced from any secure or released state testing material.

About This Edition

This 2027 Edition reflects the STAAR program **as of November 5, 2026**, including the online test format and the current question types, scoring, and TEKS blueprint. Under Texas House Bill 8 (2025), **spring 2027 is the final STAAR administration** for grades 3–8; a new assessment, the Student Success Tool, is scheduled to replace STAAR beginning in the 2027–2028 school year. This book is built to prepare students thoroughly for that final STAAR year.

While every effort has been made to ensure accuracy, test specifications can change. Families and educators should confirm current details on the official Texas Education Agency website.

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How this book is organized: First you *learn* each tested skill, then you *practice* it in short drills, then you *simulate* the real test with eight full-length practice tests, and finally you *diagnose* your results to see exactly what to study next.

Welcome to Your STAAR Grade 8 Study Guide

Dear Student,

The STAAR Grade 8 tests in Reading Language Arts and Mathematics can feel like a lot — two subjects, many skills, a timed online screen, and even written essays. This book exists to make all of that feel familiar long before test day.

Here is the promise of this book: **everything inside is on the test, and nothing on the test is left out.** Every lesson, every practice question, and every writing prompt is tied directly to the Texas Essential Knowledge and Skills (TEKS) that STAAR measures at Grade 8. You will not waste a single minute on material that will not help you.

You will move through four stages:

1. **Learn** — short, clear lessons that teach every tested skill.
2. **Practice** — quick drills so each skill sticks.
3. **Simulate** — eight full-length practice tests that look and feel like the real thing.
4. **Diagnose** — answer explanations and charts that show you exactly what to review next.

Work at a steady pace, check every answer explanation (even for questions you got right), and use the diagnostic charts to spend your study time where it matters most. Confidence on test day comes from practice, and this book gives you plenty.

You can do this. Let's get started.

— *Adrian Ross*

A note for parents and teachers: A full guide for supporting a student with this book — including how to read the diagnostic charts and how to coach the written responses — begins on the "A Guide for Parents and Teachers" page near the back.

How to Use This Book

This book works for three kinds of readers. Find the path that fits you.

Path A — The Student Studying on Your Own

1. **Start with "Getting Started."** Read how the test works, how it is scored, and how the online question types look on paper. About 30 minutes — and it saves you from surprises.
2. **Pick a study calendar.** Use the 4-Week Sprint if the test is close, or the 8-Week Plan if you have more time.
3. **Learn, then practice.** Read the skill lessons and do the warm-up drills before a full test.
4. **Take one full test at a time, under test-like conditions** — quiet room, no phone, timed.
5. **Review every explanation,** including for questions you answered correctly.
6. **Fill in your diagnostic chart** after each test, then study your weakest strand next.

Path B — The Parent or Tutor Helping a Student

- Use the **"A Guide for Parents and Teachers"** section at the back first.
- Sit with the student for the **first** practice test to model pacing, then let them work more independently.
- Focus praise on **effort and strategy**, not just the score. The tracking sheets make growth visible.

Path C — The Classroom Teacher

- Lessons and drills map one-to-one to the **TEKS**; the **TEKS Coverage Index** lists where every standard is taught and practiced.
- Each full-length test is blueprint-matched — usable as a benchmark or mock administration.
- Explanations include the TEKS code and *why each wrong choice is wrong*, useful for reteaching.

The Symbols You Will See

Symbol	Meaning
★	**Readiness standard** — tested heavily every year. Master these first.
○	**Supporting standard** — tested less often, but still fair game.

Key Idea	The one thing to remember from a lesson.
Watch Out	A common Grade 8 mistake to avoid.
Try It	A quick practice item to check yourself.
Strategy	A test-taking tip tied to the question in front of you.

Tip: Keep a pencil, scratch paper, and the Grade 8 Mathematics Reference Sheet nearby while you work. On the real test these tools are available to you — practice using them now.

Inside the STAAR Grade 8 Test

The Final STAAR Year

STAAR — the State of Texas Assessments of Academic Readiness — measures how well students have learned the **Texas Essential Knowledge and Skills (TEKS)** for their grade. Under Texas House Bill 8 (2025), **spring 2027 is the last STAAR administration** for grades 3–8. A new assessment called the Student Success Tool is scheduled to replace it in 2027–2028. This book prepares you fully for that final STAAR year.

A Computer-Based Test

STAAR is given **online**, on a computer. The real test includes question types beyond simple multiple choice — you might type an answer, choose from a drop-down menu, drag items into place, or build an equation. A paper book can't make you click and drag, so this book does the next best thing: it **shows every online question type on paper** and teaches you exactly how to answer it. The *thinking* is identical; only the clicking is different.

What Grade 8 Students Take

At Grade 8, students are assessed in **Reading Language Arts, Mathematics, Science, and Social Studies.** This book focuses on the two taken by every Grade 8 student every year: **Reading Language Arts and Mathematics.**

The Mathematics Test at a Glance

Feature	Grade 8 Mathematics
Total questions	**40**
Total points	**48** (32 one-point + 8 two-point questions)
Reporting categories (strands)	4 — Numerical; Computations & Algebraic; Geometry & Measurement; Data & Financial Literacy
Question types	Multiple choice, multiselect, inline choice, text entry/griddable, drag-and-drop, equation editor, graphing
Tools provided	**Calculator** and the **Grade 8 Mathematics Reference Sheet**

The Reading Language Arts Test at a Glance

Feature	Grade 8 Reading Language Arts
Total questions	**~45**
Total points	**56**
Reading section	~28 questions / ~30 points — includes **2 Short Constructed Responses** (2 pts each)
Writing section (Revising & Editing)	~17 questions / ~26 points — includes **1 Extended Constructed Response** (10 pts)
Passages	Literary and informational; single passages and a paired set
Tools provided	Online **dictionary/thesaurus**

How Much Time?

STAAR for grades 3–8 is given with a generous time window of **up to four hours**. It is **not a speed test** — most students finish comfortably. Still, practicing with a timer builds a steady, calm pace.

> **Watch Out:** Written responses carry real points — up to **14 of the 56 RLA points** come from the SCRs and ECR. Never leave them blank. A partial, organized response almost always earns more than nothing.

How STAAR Is Scored

From Raw Points to a Performance Level

Each question earns **raw points** (1 or 2 for most; the Extended Constructed Response is worth 10). Your total raw points convert to a **scale score**, which places you in one of four **performance levels**:

Performance Level	What It Means
Masters Grade Level	Strong command of the grade's content; ready for the next grade with little support.
Meets Grade Level	Solid understanding; likely to succeed next grade with some support.
Approaches Grade Level	Some understanding; likely needs targeted support next grade.
Did Not Meet Grade Level	Not enough understanding yet; needs significant support.

The goal for most students is **Meets Grade Level** or higher — and this book is built to get you there.

How Written Responses Are Scored

- **Short Constructed Response (SCR)** — a few sentences answering a specific question, scored **0 to 2 points**. Earn full credit by making a clear point and backing it with correct **evidence from the text**.
- **Extended Constructed Response (ECR)** — a full multi-paragraph essay, scored **0 to 10 points**. The rubric rewards a clear central idea or claim, organized paragraphs, specific supporting evidence, and correct language and conventions.

You will learn to earn these points step by step in the **SCR Mastery** and **ECR Mastery** sections, which include real-style prompts and sample responses scored at high, middle, and low levels.

Tracking Your Own Scores

After each practice test, use the **Score-Tracking Sheets** and **Strand Diagnostic Charts** at the back. They turn raw points into a performance estimate and show you **which strand or skill to study next.** Watching your scores climb from Test 1 to Test 4 is the clearest sign your work is paying off.